MIKKEL RIDLEY

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SUMMARY

- 6 years building user-facing web applications in React, TypeScript, JavaScript, and modern frontend ecosystems - from 2-person startup teams to Alphabet-scale enterprise (180,000+ employees) and a multi-billion-dollar, multi-hospital academic health system - backed by 5+ prior years of formal team management experience.
- Led a documentation and support-process overhaul that cut support tickets 30% and repetitive issues 75%, on top of shipping production UI across six distinct technology stacks (React, Angular, ASP.NET, Shopify/Liquid, Jekyll) in the last 6 years.
- Designed and shipped a full-stack conversational BI platform end-to-end as sole engineer, including a 4-tier LLM router that cut measured cost ~73% vs. an all-Opus baseline while reaching 100% SQL success on the top-performing model
- Track record of measurable delivery: 3x faster IT ticket response times, 25% faster page loads, 50% less developer time per site launch, and zero critical defects in a WCAG 2.1 AA compliance sprint.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Front End: React, TypeScript, Next.js, Angular, JavaScript (ES6+), SCSS, TailwindCSS, Material UI

APIs & Data: REST APIs, backend data flow, SQL, Node.js, ASP.NET (C#), Python/FastAPI, ClickHouse

AI / LLM Integration: OpenAI/Anthropic/Gemini APIs, RAG (ChromaDB), multi-tenant LLM tier routing, LangSmith/Langfuse observability, Vanna, Pytest-based model evaluation

Testing & Delivery: Jest, CI/CD, Git, GitHub, GitLab, Agile development, Azure, AWS, Vercel, Docker

Performance & Accessibility: Frontend debugging, performance optimization, code splitting, lazy loading, Lighthouse, PageSpeed, WCAG/ADA/ARIA, Axe

Blockchain / Web3: Solidity, Hardhat, smart contracts, wallet/ENS integration, Dune Analytics/SQL

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer, Stealth Startups (Contract) | Remote | May 2025 - Present

Contract engineering for early-stage, bootstrapped startups while building an independent founder project; work below is organized by engagement.

AI Assistant - Founder Project

- Built an AI résumé assistant (Next.js/React, serverless API routes, multi-provider LLM fallback across Anthropic, OpenAI, and Gemini, LangSmith/Langfuse observability) as a live founder project; the architecture caught the attention of a bootstrapped startup CEO, who contracted a more sophisticated version for their BI use case - becoming the platform below.

NL-to-SQL Analytics Platform - contracted engagement for a profitable stealth startup client

- Architected and built a full-stack, multi-tenant conversational BI platform as sole engineer - Remix/React frontend, FastAPI backend, Vanna-to-ClickHouse retrieval, ChromaDB RAG for schema memory - for a stealth client serving customers with $10M-$100M+ in annual revenue.
- Built a 4-tier LLM router (Haiku through Opus) with complexity-based routing and error-driven escalation, validated with a 103-query benchmark suite and 86 SQL accuracy tests.
- Escalated only ~12% of calls above the base tier, cutting cost by ~73% vs. an all-Opus baseline, while reaching 100% SQL execution success before release through a combination of automated testing and targeted prompt engineering (up from an 86% baseline).
- Evaluated 15-20 open-source and commercial LLMs on SQL quality, instruction following, latency, and hosting tradeoffs; recommended managed APIs after cost/ops analysis ruled out self-hosting at production scale.
- Delivered production-grade POC on scope and on contract, handing off a fully documented architecture to the client's engineering team.

DeFi Analytics Dashboards - delivered to a stealth startup

- Shipped 4 Dune Analytics dashboards for a second client: complex SQL pipelines over large on-chain datasets supporting real-time financial analysis.

Software Engineer - Full Stack, SFMOMA | San Francisco, CA | Sep 2023 - May 2025

The San Francisco Museum of Modern Art is a leading nonprofit contemporary art museum drawing roughly 600,000 visitors annually; owned frontend features for its public ticketing platform (~$3M in yearly sales) and internal CRM tooling.

- Delivered ticketing platform features and debugged frontend issues across ASP.NET Razor Pages, JavaScript, HTML, and SCSS.
- Integrated with Tessitura CRM data while maintaining legacy architecture and shipping new features.
- Led a WCAG 2.1 AA compliance sprint, achieving zero critical defects in pre-audit QA across the entire platform.
- Oversaw frontend prep and post-upgrade QA for .NET Core and Tessitura CRM upgrades.
- Introduced Jest testing for JavaScript components and prepared it for CI.

UI/UX Developer (Contract), Intrinsic (Alphabet/Google X) | San Francisco, CA | Jan 2023 - May 2023

Intrinsic is a robotics software company under Alphabet (180,000+ employees globally); contracted to an enterprise workflow tooling team.

- Shipped Angular/TypeScript components in Google's monorepo (Piper/Bazel) with zero P1 incidents.
- Delivered features through hermetic builds, automated regression testing, and multi-stage peer review.
- Translated Figma designs into production UI at Google scale while maintaining 100% test coverage.
- Collaborated with PMs and designers in rapid two-week sprints, presenting technical tradeoffs clearly.

Software Engineer - Front End (Contract), Jefferson Health | Remote | Nov 2021 - Jan 2023

Jefferson Health is a multi-billion-dollar, multi-hospital academic health system in the Philadelphia region; delivered internal tooling and an institute's storefront.

- Built a React/TypeScript/Next.js IT support ticket-routing tool, improving support ticket response times 3x.
- Modernized the entire Shopify development workflow: migrated to GitHub integration with protected branches, Shopify CLI for local dev, and automatic deployments, creating a proper dev-to-test-to-prod pipeline; trained the team on new practices.
- Migrated Shopify 1.x to 2.0, converting all Liquid templates to JSON schema and doubling admin panel speed.
- Reduced storefront load time ~25% through performance optimization (code-splitting, lazy loading, deferral).

Software Engineer - Front End, Dental Game Plan | Remote | Apr 2021 - Dec 2021

Dental Game Plan is an early-stage marketing and technology startup building websites and lead-generation tools for dental practices nationwide.

- Regularly shipped React/TypeScript/Next.js landing pages for various clients throughout tenure.
- Shipped 6 Jekyll static site generator sites for healthcare clients; updated and optimized existing client sites.
- Extended the custom SSG framework architecture, reducing developer time 50% for future site launches.

Software Engineer - Front End, Kul Inc. | Remote | May 2020 - Mar 2021

Kul (later rebranded QUL) was a direct-to-consumer eCommerce startup; owned the storefront build-out and platform migration.

- Second technical hire; owned the entire Shopify storefront (Hydrogen/React with built-in commerce providers and backend integrations) while the company explored multiple revenue models.
- Led a full rebrand and migration over 3 weeks with zero downtime during a strategic pivot.
- Built the frontend for a rewards system with data visualization and charts (c3.js, d3.js, Three.js).
- Optimized storefront performance, cutting load times ~18% (code-splitting, lazy loading, deferral).

Manager, Marathon Products, Inc. | San Leandro, CA | 2015 - 2020

Marathon Products is a small B2B manufacturer of data-logging hardware and software; managed the production department and internal IT/QA operations, reporting directly to the founders.

- Built a Help Desk ticketing system from scratch, improving response times by 50% with zero lost tickets since launch.
- Led a documentation overhaul - doubling coverage and restructuring for accessibility - cutting support tickets 30% and repetitive issues 75%.
- Drove Bug Tracking system adoption, increasing fix speed 25% through better collaboration with offshore and local engineering teams.
- Administered ISO 9001 QA standards, managing documentation and coordinating internal and external audits.